

interested in doing with a virtual machine, here are a few good tips for you make virtual machines more useful and scenarios in which they can help!

Testing new operating systems

Windows 8 is all over the internet and enthusiasts have already begun experimenting with the OS. You might just be one of the many who're thinking of trying it out in beta to check out its features even before it's live on the desktop. Placing all excitement aside, there's the risk of the beta version not being stable enough, or your favorite/required applications not working. Also, setting it up as a parallel OS might be a risk if something goes wrong and you happen to lose all the important work, the whole software and multimedia collection on your system. Additionally, Windows is known to overwrite the boot loaders when you install the new version and then removal of the newer version becomes the difficulty. That's one of those reasons which keep most people from trying out the beta releases.

It's very obvious that virtualization is the solution to all that. If you want to test out a new operating system to check out the features or do some work, just install it as a virtual machine. If you like it, you can install it as the real operating system later. For the Linux distro-hoppers, who are a lot into trying out new Linux distributions, this is the perfect solution. If you want to know what great looks does the new Linux distribution have or what are the new features, run the OS as a virtual machine! Trying out new kernel or file systems was never so easy. If you want to see for yourself the new graphics effects Gnome 3 brings to you, VMware Workstation will not let you down! VirtualBox is not bad either – don't forget to enable the 3D acceleration, though!

There's one thing to remember when trying out operating systems and this is perhaps the third time we're saying this, but we must repeat – don't use virtual machines to test your hardware compatibility – virtualization is all about faking the hardware to the OS. You being able to run an OS in a virtual machine doesn't give any guarantee at all for it running smoothly on your real system.

Testing new software without slowing down your system

If you've been a creative professional who designs visuals using Adobe Photoshop and have been waiting since a year for the new release of your favorite software package because it would contain a feature you wanted badly, you'd know the value of virtualization.

